

nt | Resource that outlines process for managing renewals as a part of the larger account team (with SAEs, CSMs, Customer Success) |
| ISR Renewal Management | Shared doc | A shared document outlining the renewal management process for ISRs |
| Community Education / EDU Program | Developer Relations | Resource that outlines The GitLab for Education Program which provides GitLab for free to students and faculty at educational institutions around the globe |

ISR Manager Resources

Link	Type	Purpose
-----	-----	-----
Territory Change Request Sales Operations This process is used by sales operations, ISR management, and regional sales directors to update ISR alignment		
ISR Overrides ISR Manager Process This process allows the ISR Management team to override any automation associated with the population of the ISR field on an opportunity. This should be used in scenarios where an ISR is working an opportunity that is not aligned with one of their territories.		

SECTION: sales/it-agility-director-interview.md

Introduction

Below are clips from an April 2020 interview with an IT Agility Director at a Fortune 500 energy company.

Roles and Responsibilities

Question: What was your role and responsibilities for the last several years?

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DevOps Project Goals

Question: What were the goals of your organization's DevOps program?

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DevOps Project Areas of Focus and Organization

Question: What was the focus of your organization's DevOps project and how was the team organized?

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allowfullscreen="true"> </iframe>
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DevOps Roll Out Strategy

Question: What was your DevOps roll out strategy? Were there specific use cases or capabilities on which you chose to focus?

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allowfullscreen="true"> </iframe>
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Challenges with a Fragmented DevOps Toolchain Approach

Question: How and why did your organization choose a best-of-breed DevOps toolchain approach and what challenges did you face with this decision?

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allowfullscreen="true"> </iframe>
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DevOps Program Challenges and Lessons Learned

Question: What were some of the challenges and lessons learned you experienced with your DevOps program?

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allowfullscreen="true"> </iframe>
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DevSecOps

Question: What is your perspective on the importance of DevSecOps?

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A Day in the Life of an IT Director

Question: What is the day in the life of an IT Director like?

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Advice for B2B Salespeople

Question: What separates a great vendor or sales person from an average vendor or salesperson?
If you could offer one piece of advice to B2B salespeople, what would that be and why?

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Tool Selection Process

Question: How did your organization typically evaluate and make the decision to buy a new tool or service?

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allowfullscreen="true"> </iframe>
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COVID-19 Advice

Question: What advice do you have for B2B sellers during the COVID-19 pandemic?

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SECTION: sales/meddppicc.md

Overview

MEDDPPICC is a proven methodology used for strategic opportunity management and complex sales process orchestration for enterprise organizations and is an acronym for:

- Metrics
- Economic Buyer
- Decision Process
- Decision Criteria
- Partner
- Paper Process
- Identify Pain
- Champion
- Competition

Qualify your opportunities throughout the sales process (but especially during the "1-Discovery" and "2-Scoping" stages) leveraging the resources below to put yourself in the best position to earn the customer's business. MEDDPICC is part of the Command Plan and is required for all new business opportunities above a certain threshold (see Opportunity Management Requirements for additional details).

Resources

- MEDDPICC training slides
- MEDDPICC template
- Opportunity Qualifier

Metrics

(M) Metrics: the economic impact of the solution

Video

Check out the [Demystifying the Metrics Conversation Handbook](#) page.

Qualifying Questions

- What is the business case?
- Have you quantified the challenge(s) the customer is having and the impact to the organization?
- What quantifiable metrics/measurements have been identified?
 - Top-line metrics include quicker time to market, higher quality (improvements towards sales and revenue)
 - Bottom line metrics include reduction in operating costs
- How will you prove the business benefits of the solution?
- Has the customer bought into your Metrics?
- Are your Metrics aligned with the desired business outcomes?
- Is your Champion(s) leveraging your Metrics?
- Are your Metrics in the business justification or decision criteria (or both)?
- Has the Economic Buyer made reference calls based on your Metrics?

Economic Buyer

(E) Economic Buyer: the individual within the customer's organization who is required for the final "yes"

Video

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Qualifying Questions

- Have you identified and met with the Economic Buyer(s) (EB) (the individual(s) who has the power to spend and/or has profit/loss responsibility for this solution)?
- How do you know they're actually the EB (versus someone higher in the organization)?
- How can you leverage your Champion to gain access?
- What does the Economic Buyer(s) care about most?
- How do you establish credibility with your EB(s)?
- How will you leverage your EB(s) during key decision events and milestones?

Decision Process

(D) Decision Process: the process and timeline by which the customer will evaluate, select, and purchase a solution

Video

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Qualifying Questions

- What will the decision-making process look like?
- What steps are included in the customer's decision process?
- What key stakeholders are involved in the Decision Process and what do we know about them?
- How will the decision ultimately be made (e.g. one person's influence, decision by committee)?
- How have you influenced the Decision Process in favor of GitLab?
- Have you documented all of the validation and approval activities/steps?
- Have you developed a reverse timeline and workback plan?
- Are you and the customer vested in the above workback plan?
- Have you reviewed and socialized the timeline with all interested parties?
- Who can change the process?

Decision Criteria

(D) Decision Criteria: the formal solution requirements against which each participant in the decision process will evaluate (includes the technical and financial lens with which the customer views GitLab)

Video

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Qualifying Questions

- What is the customer's criteria for selection?

- What is the Business Decision Criteria (BDC)?
- What is the Technical Decision Criteria (TDC)?
- What are the highest priority Required Capabilities?
- How will these criteria be weighted during the decision process?
- Have all key customer stakeholders helped shape the above requirements?
- How have you influenced (or how are you actively influencing) the Decision Criteria in favor of GitLab?
- How does our technology align with their technical wish list?
- How does our subscription model align with how they usually buy software?
- What other criteria have they told us about?

Partner

(P) Partner: the process of validating the partner landscape and opportunity implications

Video

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Qualifying Questions

- What cloud platform(s) is the customer using?
- Who is/are the customer's trusted fulfillment partner, system integrator, and/or trusted advisor?
- What alliance relationships/incentives can and should be leveraged to influence and accelerate the sales cycle?
- Is there a channel partner involved that might slow down/speed up the order process?
- Is there a partner involved (systems integrator or other) that is helping/influencing the technology decision?

Paper Process

(P) Paper Process: the process by which the customer will document and execute the process of purchasing (including the MSA, order form, PO, etc.)

Video

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Qualifying Questions

- What does the purchasing (budget and funding release) process entail?
- What paperwork will be required to make the purchase happen?
- Do you know how each step gets approved? Are there any SLAs we need to be aware of along the

way?

- Does the purchasing process include a board or committee review/approval?
- How has this process and timeline expectations for each step been documented and communicated?
- Is there a legal team involved in contract negotiations?
- Who is involved in this and how long does it take?
- What does a purchase of this size look like?
- Has a purchase of this size happened before?
- Do you know who the actual signer is? Is there more than one signatory?
- Do you know if the PO gets automatically generated once the business approves the order form or if the PO needs to also get approved by someone in purchasing/procurement?
- Is there enough time left in the quarter to complete this?

Identify Pain

(I) Identify Pain: the problems created by the customer's current state (nobody buys until there is pain!)

Video

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Qualifying Questions

- What are the customer's primary objectives with this project or initiative?
- What are the biggest business and technical pains?
- Are those pains resulting in lost productivity, reduced revenues, increased costs, etc.?
- How severe is the pain?
- How long have they been dealing with this pain?
- Who has the pain and who is in charge of fixing it? What happens if they don't fix it (or don't fix it by or before a specific point in time)? (Commercial Account Executives are expected to identify this person by name and role within the Command Plan --> Identify Pain section prior to requesting a GitLab Demo delivered by a GitLab Solution Architect)
- How does your Champion and Economic Buyer prioritize this pain?
- Where have we solved this pain before?
- Does the customer perceive that the pain of change is less than the pain of doing nothing and sticking with the status quo?
- What is the customer's compelling event and how does that add to the pain they are experiencing?
- What information do we have to justify the recommended solution?

Champion

(C) Champion: the person(s) with power and influence inside the customer's organization who are actively selling on your behalf and willing to give you inside information to help you win the deal

Video

Check out the below podcasts

- Coaches vs. Champions (12.5 minutes)
- How to Test Your Champion (11 minutes)

Qualifying Questions

- Who is your Champion?
- Does this person know they are your Champion?
- How do you know if you're working with a champion vs. a coach?
- Is your Champion strong enough to help you connect the dots, give you access to people, and tell you if you're on track or not?
- How is your Champion(s) aligned within the organization?
- How have you tested them to ensure they are a true Champion?
- Who are your other potential Champions?

Competition

(C) Competition: competitive strengths, weaknesses, and differentiators, including competitor's champions

Video

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Qualifying Questions

- Who is our top competition in this opportunity?
- Who are your internal and external competitors?
- Where are we strong (Differentiators) and where are we weak relative to the competition as perceived by the customer (perception is reality!)?
- Have you discussed this with your client?
- Who are your competitors' Champions and what is their champion's role and level of influence?
- What is the competition's relative power and influence in the account?
- What is your plan to counter your competition's sales strategy?

SECTION: sales/negotiate-to-close.md

Overview

A sales negotiation is a strategic discussion (or series of discussions) between buyer and seller that ideally leads to a deal being closed. The main goal of the negotiation process is to reach an agreement that's acceptable to everyone. Successful negotiation outcomes often

start with the sales professional having and demonstrating the right mindset -- one focused on building a long-term partnership whereby both parties (buyer and seller) benefit more by working together than if the partnership did not exist.

In his book *Closing Time*, Ron Hubsher highlights the 7 immutable laws of sales negotiation:

1. You must be the buyer's first choice
1. Know the financial benefit your solution creates
1. Anticipate getting squeezed on price
1. Be proactive on budget and remove decision-making obstacles in advance
1. Expand the pie with a set of non-monetary trade-ups
1. Never give without getting
1. Know your walk-away price and conditions

When do negotiations start?

Preparing for a negotiation starts as early as your first conversation, and successful negotiation outcomes begin with embracing a value-based sales methodology like *Command of the Message* from the very onset of the sales process.

5 1/2 tips for how to approach price-lock negotiations at GitLab

In this video, VP of Enterprise Sales - Mike Pyle, gives tips for how to approach price-lock negotiations at GitLab while protecting the value of our product during these negotiations. The key to doing this well is consistently and proactively having this conversation. This guidance is useful no matter the size of your prospect or customer. Watch below or go directly to GitLab Unfiltered to view: *5 1/2 Tips for Getting Ahead of Price-lock Negotiations* (YouTube, 10 minutes).

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src="https://www.youtube.com/embed/mzGc1bXESzI"></iframe></figure>In addition to these tips, the below critical sales skills will also help you achieve a successful negotiation:

Uncover customer needs

Conduct effective, ongoing discovery to:

- Obtain a deep understanding of the customer's current state (see Sales Discovery and Qualification Questions)
- Identify the Positive Business Outcomes they want or need to achieve (and why), and
- Co-create a shared vision for the Required Capabilities to get from the current state to the desired future state

Articulate value and differentiation

Don't start a negotiation if you are not the buyer's first choice. With a thorough understanding of your customer's needs, be sure to:

- Effectively articulate how GitLab will address the customer's requirements (leverage these core resources) (internal only)

- Successfully connect the dots between technical metrics and the business value that GitLab delivers (see Demystifying the Metrics Conversation), and
- Share relevant proof points that highlight how and why GitLab can deliver against the customer's requirements better than any other option(s) available

Closing

The Command Plan provides a framework to maximize your likelihood of winning and securing the customer's business for a defined purchase initiative. Before even attempting to move to Close, be sure you have compelling answers to every component of the Opportunity Overview section of the Command Plan.

While there are numerous closing techniques out there, the LinkedIn Learning course referenced below recommends four common closing techniques (these need not be mutually exclusive):

1. The Summary Close - reiterating all the key benefits of your offer as they relate to the customer's prioritized requirements before you ask for the order
1. The Balance Sheet Close - collaboratively making a list of pros and cons to help the customer feel more comfortable with the decision to move forward (note: be sure you are confident that the pros significantly outweigh the cons!)
1. The Needs Close - methodically go through the list of all of the customer's requirements to explicitly show how you are addressing their needs and will help them achieve their desired results
1. The Assumptive Close - gently nudging the customer to move forward in a non-manipulative way when it seems clear that your solution meets all of the customer's requirements (most effective when you have an established and trusted relationship with the buyer)

Recommended resources

- Closing Time by Ron Hubsher
- LinkedIn Learning course: Sales: Closing Strategies (38 minutes)
- LinkedIn Learning course: Sales Negotiation (58 minutes)
- Finding Success With Procurement (podcast, 22 minutes)
- Never Split the Difference: Negotiating As If Your Life Depended On It by Chris Voss

SECTION: sales/prospect-engagement-best-practices.md

This page contains tips on how to associate emails to Salesforce.

Associating Emails to Opportunities

Associating emails to Salesforce is a best practice that should be followed by all users. Attaching emails to a Lead, Account, Contact, or Opportunity record are vital for transparency, as any number of team members can review the correspondence between GitLab and the customer/prospect account.

It doesn't do anyone any good when all of the correspondence is kept in a user's inbox.

With that said, there are multiple ways that an email can be associated to an opportunity.

But before you do that, you must first make sure that the contact record is associated to an opportunity via the Contact Roles object.

First, Contact Roles

To add a Contact Role to an opportunity:

1. Go to the Opportunity.
1. Go to the Contact Role related list.
1. Click 'New'.
1. Add the Contact.
1. If this person is your primary contact, click on the 'Primary' radio button.
1. Add the Role this person plays in the opportunity (Economic Buyer, Technical Buyer, etc).
1. Repeat the steps, although you can only have one Primary Contact per opportunity.
1. For more information, you can visit the Salesforce Knowledge Center.

Email to Salesforce

Email to Salesforce allows you to associate emails to Opportunities using an email long email string that associates the email to the contact.

To set this up:

1. Click on your 'Name' on the top right of any page in Salesforce.
1. Select 'My Settings'
1. Go to the left sidebar and click 'Email'.
1. Then click 'My Email to Salesforce'.
1. Copy the email string.
1. Go to My Acceptable Email Addresses and make sure your GitLab email address is there.
1. In 'Email Associations', make sure "Automatically assign them to Salesforce records" is checked.
1. Check Opportunities, Leads, and Contacts.
1. In the Leads and Contacts section, make sure to select "All Records".
1. It is up to you if you want to save all attachments, as well as if you want to receive an email confirmation of an association (my recommendation is yes for the first few weeks to make sure it's working, then you can turn it off anytime).
1. Click Save.
1. Go to Gmail and save this email address in a Contact record. A good practice is name it 'BCC SFDC' for first and last name.
1. When you send any emails from Gmail, you will BCC the "BCC SFDC" contact, which will send the email to long string you copied in Step 5.

Outreach

If you want to associate emails to Opportunities using Outreach, follow these steps:

1. Go to your photo on the bottom left.
1. Click Settings
1. Select 'Plugins' on the left menu.
1. Select the SFDC (Salesforce) plugin.
1. Click on 'Contact'.

1. On the bottom right, enable 'Automatically associate activity with Opportunity'
1. Click the 'Save' button on the top right.

Salesforce Plugin for Gmail

If you want to associate emails to Opportunities or other records using the Salesforce Plugin for Gmail plug in, follow these steps:

1. Visit the Chrome Store to download the Salesforce Plugin for Gmail plug in.
1. Click Add to Chrome
1. Click Add Extension
1. Go to Gmail and open the right sidebar.
1. When you open an email that may contain email addresses from existing leads or contacts in Salesforce, all related records associated to that email (Lead, Contact, Account, Opportunity, and Cases) will appear, and you can select any or all records to related the email to.
1. For each record you'd like to associate the email to, click on the upload icon for each record.
1. If you wish, you can include some or all of the attachments to the record as well by clicking the checkbox next to each attachment.

If you have any issues with the setup, please contact the Director of Sales Operations via Slack, email, or SFDC Chatter.

SECTION: sales/prospecting.md

What is prospecting at GitLab?

All AEs are expected to have good pipeline generation coverage regardless of their role or types of accounts. The more you can integrate good pipe gen habits into your everyday activities, the easier it will be to have a strong pipeline throughout the year and with less maintenance. Watch the latest on prospecting best practices from recent AEs on Highspot. In this video, several AEs across AMER and EMEA talk about what helped them achieve their goals in prospecting and offer tips you can apply to your strategy right away, in addition to what's here on this page.

Prospecting has come a long way from cold calling: In Enterprise Sales, prospecting is strategic, thoughtful, helpful, and almost always a warm connection.

What is warm? Warm is when you know there's a good reason why you need to reach out to your prospect, it's for their benefit that you're getting in touch, and you know why they're likely to need your solution now.

You own your pipeline. For enterprise account executives (AEs), prospecting should be a part of your regular sales activities. This means blocking dedicated time on your calendar to plan, strategize with your team, and reach out to your top prospects every single week. After all, if you don't have a pipeline, you don't have a business. And as the CEO of your territory or area, you need to dedicate time to your future business as much as your current business to reach your target.

It takes a team effort to achieve results. The AE owns the customer relationship, but all team members can and should participate in strategy, planning, and execution. AEs should work closely with their sales development reps (SDRs), channel account manager, and also sync with their Field Marketing team member.

Team is external, too. Think about the technology partners that can help you scale your approach. Engage with these partners, identify the right entry point, and present GitLab jointly with the partner to your customer. Exercise the muscle of engaging early and working with partners to identify new customers.

Here are a few things to keep in mind about Prospecting at GitLab:

1. Good prospecting feels like a conversation. Cookie-cutter copy blocks, technical jargon, and generic language don't get results. Custom, tailored, and specific messages do. This takes a lot more work, but the ROI is worth it and you should factor additional time to plan, strategize, and write into your approach. A lot of the tools included in this toolkit are designed to help you do this efficiently.
2. You need to earn the attention of your customer or prospect. It's not guaranteed. If you don't know why they should be talking to you over anyone else in the world - then you need to refine both your message and your target list. After all, they do not owe you a response or a message back, it is earned. A great way to earn the attention of your prospect is to know more about their strategic technology initiatives or partnerships. It shows you've done your research and elevates your conversation to alignment with something the business has prioritized and budgeted for.
3. You're the expert on GitLab, they're the expert on their business. You know what they say about assumptions? It's important to keep in mind that no one knows your customer's business better than they do. It's your job to keep them in the loop on what solutions we offer that could help them be more effective now or down the line - but don't assume it's what's best for them. In every prospecting call or message, it should be clear that you're offering to advise them, not tell them what's best for them.

Build your strategy

Start from your territory plan. This exercise should be your source of information on where you're prioritizing your time and what activities you and your team think will be most effective. It's also where you've set your pipeline generation target.

What is my target? Pipeline targets for every AE are loaded into Clari the first or second week of every quarter.

Working backwards from your target, you'll be able to calculate how many accounts and opportunities you need to be successful. When looking at your target list, make sure you have a mix of those who are likely to buy now and those who may take a year or longer. Strategic partnerships take time so you need to diversify both your list and your outreach.

Work with your Sales Development team member to:

- Get input on your territory plan and how that maps to their activities.

- Review activity and engagement in 6Sense.
- Develop your approach and identify the right messaging.

Use data to support your assumptions:

- Account data: Target accounts that have new leadership, show recent Merger & Acquisition activity, or have contacts who are posting relevant content on social media. Reach out to GitLab advocates and champions when they transition to new target accounts.
- Engagement data: Target prospects that have recently engaged with GitLab marketing activity or website content multiple times.
- Intent data: Target accounts that have demonstrated interest in a competitor and relevant industry trends.

Next, plan your approach and sequence with your team. Have regular pipeline generation reviews and meetings (whether async or live) with your sales development team members and wider team to get input and advice on your approach.

Collaborating on your strategy

Work with your Sales Development team member to:

- Decide which format of approach is best (email, linkedin, phone), and what your cadence will be:
- Customize the Prospecting Sequences for AEs template or create your own.
- Organize the qualifying questions and customer use cases that might be relevant.
- Practice your elevator pitch. Both you and your SD teammate need to practice your pitches together to make sure you're aligned on what you want the customer or prospect to hear. Really work on your tone of voice. You know you're ready if you can easily tweak it based on who you're talking to and what's relevant to them.

Work with partners: Work with your Channel Account Manager (CAM), talk to your peers, or use the Partner Directory to identify if there is a partner that supports specific accounts and can provide insight into target contacts or stakeholders.

Work with Field Marketing: Learn what events are currently scheduled in your region and view the name of your aligned field marketer.

View the below YouTube video hosted on GitLab Unfiltered to see how AEs typically work with their sales development team member to get results. Remember that to view these, you have to switch your YouTube account to the GitLab Unfiltered account first. View instructions for this on the YouTube handbook page [here](#).

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Put your strategy into action

Use the Pipeline Generation Toolkit for Enterprise AEs to get started on prospecting.

Remember to triple-check your messages before you send them to prospects and customers. Getting details about them and their company wrong is cited in the State of Sales 2021 report as one of the top deal-breakers in the eyes of buyers.

Outbound Wednesday

Teams at GitLab find success when they dedicate time to prospecting and customer-centric activity. Whether you're meeting with a prospect, a partner, or with growth customers, setting up an Outbound day to focus on bringing customer's value can boost your results and let your team members know not to schedule or pre-book internal meetings during your dedicated customer time.

AMER's Outbound Wednesday Initiative

- Mission: In alignment with the GitLab Value of Iteration, we want to give time back to the customer-facing teams, AEs, SAs, BDRs, TAMs / CSMs, ISRs, and Channel Account Managers, to allow for customer focus and partner-facing time. In addition, we feel it will allow for more significant customer and partner collaboration.
- Why it matters: We recognize that there is an abundance of internal meetings and requests. To help foster more customer centricity, we have developed the concept of "Outbound Wednesdays."
- What it is: Use your best efforts not to pre-book internal meetings on a Wednesday. If on a Wednesday, feel free to schedule a same-day meeting to collaborate with the critical stakeholders on customer activities.
- Beliefs:
 - Block out Wednesdays for Outbound activity
 - Dedicate 20%+ of your week to meeting face-to-face with customers
 - Prioritize live syncs with customers and make it easy for them to do it
 - Drive activities and resources to help you have more customer meetings
 - Be available to show customer-centricity as ONE team

Exceptions:

Outbound Wednesdays are not a mandate; however, a recommendation for our Americas Enterprise teams to use their best efforts only to pre-book customer and partner meetings. For managers, this would include customers, partners, and recruiting. They can still happen if we need to have same-day internal discussions on a Wednesday. There will be the time in people's calendars for same-day meetings.

The goal is to avoid scheduling such meetings in advance. By doing this together as a "ONE AMER ENT Team", we will find that it will help to provide an environment where customer-centric collaboration can more easily happen. By striving to reduce internal meetings on Wednesdays, we should be taking the initiative to operate asynchronously with team members whenever possible. We can follow up with an internal discussion on subsequent days where synchronous collaboration is needed to clarify any misunderstandings.

Read the overview in Google Drive and contribute.

Keep your pipeline healthy

Generally, surprises - whether in the form of sudden, major deals or sudden, major losses - are a bad thing. We have to strive to create predictable results. At first, this seems like trying to predict the vast unknown. But if you have a strong strategy in place for your pipeline, you'll be able to see exactly how your year will turn out well before it happens. This means better, more reliable forecasts and less stress for you on whether you'll meet that target.

Validate, validate, validate. Effective qualification is just the first step. As you invest in a prospect, it's important to continuously validate the opportunity throughout the sales cycle and make sure it can deliver results for you and that we are the effective solution for the prospect.

Use data to validate your opportunities. If you're making big bets because you 'hope' a prospect will change their mind it's a sign that you need to go back to the validation process:

- What evidence do you have that this deal is 'real'?
- What data tells you it will happen this quarter or next?
- What is not being talked about is usually a sign something is not going as planned. For example, do you know their paper process inside and out? Do you know the potential people on their team that could derail the deal later?

Meet with your team and get their help and feedback on validating what's in your pipeline and hold regular meeting cadences with them to walk through your top prospects.

Keep your opps squeaky clean: Pay attention to how long something has been sitting in a specific stage, and close it out when the time is right. For a tech company, the average strategic deal takes 6 months to a year to close. While it's normal for an opportunity to sit, holding it prevents another team (or other resources) from helping it progress.

Holding hurts our prospective customers because while they're sitting there, they aren't getting any real value from us (and likely to get more value from a competitor). It's for their benefit that we push deals along or move them to close.

Resources

- Sales discovery and qualifying questions handbook page
- Effective discovery handbook page
- Most common customer use cases handbook page

Training

- Pipeline Generation at GitLab (GitLab Learn - EdCast, 35 minutes)
- Effective discovery course (GitLab Learn - EdCast, 40 minutes)
- Demystifying the metrics conversation (Nico Ochoa video, 10 minutes)
- Pipeline Generation - Leading with Insights (GitLab Unfiltered, Nov 2019, 10 minutes)

Support

- Field Marketing events and support
- Compete support and Competition Slack channel
- Executive sponsorship program
- Nominate account for ABM marketing support

Partner support: channel-sales Slack channel is a great place to get help from a Channel Account Manager that can share partner contacts with you

- Find a partner in the GitLab Partner Directory
- Register a deal with our technology partners

Tools

The toolkit above will be your main resource and contains things like a sequencing template for you to copy and modify for your own pipeline generation activities. It also includes the resources below which we've described here for easier access. To explore additional tools available, check out our tech stack page.

Outreach.io is a tool used to automate emails in the form of sequences. Users can track open rates, click through rates, response rates for various templates and update sequences based on these metrics. Outreach.io also helps to track sales activities such as calls. All emails/calls/tasks that are made through Outreach.io are automatically logged in Salesforce with a corresponding disposition. See below for a list of current call dispositions, what they mean and scenarios on when to use each of them. All AEs can request access to Outreach.io by submitting an Access Request (if you do not already have access).

LinkedIn Sales Navigator is one of the main prospecting tools we use at GitLab. It features a powerful set of search capabilities, improved visibility into extended networks, and personalized algorithms to help you reach the right decision maker. All AEs have access to LSN. Click to go to the EdCast training. And view additional videos and tutorials on the handbook page.

- To gain access to LinkedIn Sales Navigator, request access through the Lumos App Store. Once access is approved, follow the Lumos-provided instructions to link your personal LinkedIn account to LISN.

6Sense is used by Sales Development who can show you relevant data related to your target prospects. It has a wealth of intent and propensity to buy data that is married with account engagement indicators to create a holistic intent mapping for each account.

Conversica is a conversational AI tool that helps enterprise marketing, sales, customer success, and finance teams attract, acquire and grow customers at scale across the customer revenue lifecycle. The AI Assistant works by engaging the prospect in a human-like conversation over email in an effort to further qualify the prospect.

Salesforce Inbox is a productivity tool to integrate Salesforce with emails. You may need to request access. View the Associating emails to Salesforce handbook page for more information on how to use Salesforce to track outreach.

SECTION: sales/public-sector.md

Government Customers/Contracting

Please see the Government Customers/Contracting Section

GitLab for Campuses

Overview

GitLab provides qualified educational institutions with two different options for using GitLab on their campus:

1. Academic Discount: GitLab licenses are available at a 20% Academic Discount off list price for any qualifying educational institution. There are no use-case restrictions on these licenses.
2. GitLab for Campuses: Qualifying educational institutions may purchase an enterprise campus-wide license. The campus-wide license offers unlimited seats (up to the last published enrollment of the institution) of GitLab's top-tiers, either self-managed or SaaS. This offering permits all use cases to occur within one license for the campus. NOTE: The ability to participate in any of the Education options (stated herein) is subject to GitLab's sole discretion. Please follow the applicable steps regarding qualification. Purchases or requests shall not be considered accepted (or legally binding) unless and until executed between the parties in writing.

Academic Discount

Qualifying educational institutions may receive an Academic Discount of 20% off the current GitLab list price for each tier, either self-managed or SaaS. The discount will be applied at the discretion of the account owner and their regional sales leadership where applicable.

- The academic discount is available as of 2021-02-01. The academic discount will not be retroactively applied to close-won deals or true-ups.
- The academic discount can be applied at the time of the renewal if it is after 2021-02-01.
- The academic discount is not currently available to be purchased directly in the GitLab Customers Portal.

GitLab for Campuses: Enterprise Offering

Qualifying educational institutions may purchase a campus-wide enterprise license.

Details

- Only the top-tier of self-managed and SaaS GitLab are available in the campus-wide offering. Lower tiers are not available. The primary goal of this offering is to provide all of campus with the best GitLab has to offer and incentivize students, faculty, and staff to adopt GitLab's highest tier features.
- A single campus-wide enterprise license can have an unlimited number of seats up to the most recently published total student enrollment of the institution.

- The institution will provide documentation to the GitLab account owner for the most recent published student enrollment numbers (graduate and undergraduate) for within one year of the date of deal closing.
- The subscription at the agreed upon enrollment tier is valid for one year from the close date. No adjustments to the tier will be made during the subscription year.
- Multiple year subscriptions are not available at this time. Institutions must purchase and renew on annual basis. Annual renewal ensures the ability to verify the enrollment tier at time of enrollment.
- The unit (or SKU) is available to an individual educational institution (see definitions below).
- The appropriate SKU will be determined based on the total number of enrolled students at the institution for the last published year of data available by the account owner.
- The institution may not request more seats than the last published enrollment number.
- The seats are available to all sub-units within the educational institution including campuses, colleges, schools, and divisions.
- The seats for each SKU are only available within the individual education institution and are not available outside of the institution. See definitions below for more details.
- Each individual educational institution within a state, regional, or national system must purchase an individual license (SKU). The license (SKU) cannot be shared across individual institutions within a system.
- The GitLab for Campuses enterprise offering is not currently available through the Customers Portal. Universities must work with their regional sales account owner to obtain a license.

Support

- A named single point of contact is provided for each college, school, or division within the institution. This reach expands to those units that serve as a primary tier administrative level for the institution. For example, the College of Engineering may have a named contact but the 8 individual departments within the College do not have a named support contact. Named support limits for Ultimate tier apply.
- The named contacts must be provided to GitLab and included in the support database. The account owner has the primary discretion to include or not include provided named support contacts based on the definitions below.
- Individual students, faculty, and staff outside of the named single point of contact for each primary division cannot directly contact GitLab support.
- Please refer customers to the GitLab Support process for Managing Support contacts and handling details in order to seed a list of named support contacts.

Tiers

The GitLab for Campuses enterprise offering is available at the following tiers:

Institution Size	Deployment	SKU Name
Up to 4,999	SaaS	[EDU Enterprise-Small] SaaS - Ultimate (formerly Gold) - 1 Year
5,000 up to 9,999	SaaS	[EDU Enterprise-Medium] SaaS - Ultimate (formerly Gold) - 1 Year
10,000 up to 24,999	SaaS	[EDU Enterprise-Large] SaaS - Ultimate (formerly Gold) - 1 Year
25,000 and over	SaaS	[EDU Enterprise-XLarge] SaaS - Ultimate (formerly Gold) - 1 Year
Up to 4,999	Self-Managed	[EDU Enterprise-Small] Self-Managed - Ultimate - 1 Year

5,000 up to 9,999	Self-Managed	[EDU Enterprise-Medium] Self-Managed - Ultimate - 1 Year
10,000 up to 24,999	Self-Managed	[EDU Enterprise-Large] Self-Managed - Ultimate - 1 Year
25,000 and over^+	Self-Managed	[EDU Enterprise-XLarge] Self-Managed - Ultimate - 1 Year

Institution size is determined by the last published student enrollment (undergraduate and graduate) within one year of the contract closing.

- System limitations require a max number of seats. The XLarge SKUs are set to a max of 50,000k seats. If the number of seats needed is higher than 50,000 the Account Owner should notify Deal Desk in SFDC before sending the quote.

Steps for Building a GitLab for Campuses Quote

The steps for building a GitLab for Campuses quote vary slightly from standard quotes.

1. Before building the quote, determine the proper tier based on the most recently published enrollment data provided by the institution.
2. After creating the opportunity and a new quote following the steps in the Sales Order Processing handbook page

- On the Select Billing Account page choose the appropriate Quote Template - 01.21 New Order Form - EDU / 01.21 Amendment Order Form - EDU / 01.21 Renewal Order Form - EDU.

- Proceed as usual until the Add base products, and Click Select Plan on the relevant product. Scroll to the appropriate product SKU names from the table above. For example, [EDU Enterprise-Small] SaaS - Ultimate (formerly Gold) - 1 Year.

- Proceed as usual.

GitLab for Campuses Order Form

The GitLab for Campuses Order form must be used for all GitLab for Campuses quotes because it contains specific language regarding the size of the institution.

Resellers

GitLab for Campuses can be sold through GitLab resellers. The specific language regarding the size of the institution from the GitLab for Campuses Order Form must be added to the Reseller Order Form.

GitLab for Campuses Agreement

The standard GitLab Subscription Agreement is applicable to the GitLab for Campuses offering.

Definitions of Qualifying Education Institutions and Associated Entities

Qualified educational institution: an institution that has been accredited by an authorized agency within its applicable local, state, provincial, federal, or national government and has the primary purpose of affording instruction and conferring degrees. Qualified educational institutions can be public or private and must be non-profit/non-commercial.

The individual educational institution maybe organized under one corporate organization and

government. Individual educational institutions generally have a uniquely identifiable email domain, governance, branding, degrees, administration, and colleges.

Individual institutions may be part of a larger state, regional, or national university system.

University or Institution Campus: individual educational institutions may have campuses located in a geographically separate locations from their main campus. The campus is generally a sub-unit of the main educational institution such that it reports to the same administration, uses the same email domain, has some level of shared degrees and services, and often the mascot and branding are shared.

University College or University School: a constituent unit or division of an educational institution. Generally, colleges are a collection of various related departments organized within its own governance within the wider educational institution structure. Colleges or schools may be named according to the types of degrees offered within the unit, for example, professional degrees or academic degrees. Colleges and schools are typically directly administered by a Dean that reports to the institution's governance.

Research centers, institutes, and center-like units: educational institutions commonly have a sub-unit organized around a specific research topic. These units may be the administrative home to faculty, students, and staff. Governance of the unit falls within the institution as a whole. Email domains, shared services, are all aligned with the primary institution.

Stand-alone College: this type of college is typically a stand-alone, entity smaller than a typical university, that emphasizes undergraduate education. Some colleges offer a broad range of academic areas while others specialize in professional or vocational training. In this U.S., there are nearly 1,000 community colleges that offer 2-year associate degrees or 4-year degrees. Stand-alone colleges are considered in an individual educational institution for the purposes of this model.

University System or Institutional System: a system is a set of affiliated universities, colleges, educational institutions, or research institutions that are geographically distributed and governed by a system-wide governing body such as a board of regents or a board of trustees.

Online Campus/University: An online campus or online university, often branded as a Global Campus, may be affiliated with a University but is often a separate entity. The entity may be legally organized as a non-profit University or as a public-benefit corporation. Wholly online campuses or universities associated with a institution are considered an individual educational institution for the purposes of this model. The eligibility of wholly online campuses and universities will be determined on a case-by-case basis at the discretion of the regional sales team. The legal organization, for-profit status, enrollment, and other factors will be examined in determining the eligibility of the entity.

For-Profit Universities/Colleges: Universities and colleges owned and operation by for-profit businesses are not eligible for the enterprise education offering.

For-Profit Units: Individual non-profit institutions may have directly affiliated entities that are managed and operated by a for-profit entity or mechanism with a separate tax status than the parent University. This may include online program managers (for-profit online programs),

endowment money managers, startup incubators, etc. For-profit units are excluded from the enterprise education offering unless specifically agreed upon by GitLab and indicated on the order form.

Educationally Related Entities: any entity that does not meet the qualifying criteria, such as code academies, massive open online course providers, bootcamps, and professional training centers, do not qualify for the GitLab for Campuses enterprise offering.

Medical Colleges

In order to be eligible for the education enterprise pricing model medical colleges must meet the following criteria:

- Be owned and operated directly by an accredited, degree-granting, non-profit, public or private, educational institution with the primary purpose of educating its enrolled students or
- Be owned and operated directly by an academic health science center.

Ineligible Entities

The following are not eligible for the GitLab for Campuses enterprise offering:

- Medical colleges directly owned or operated by a public hospital or a private hospital
- Medical colleges directly owned or operated with a integrated delivery network or system
- Medical colleges affiliated but with a University but not owned and operated by that University
- Medical colleges or teaching facilities owned and operated by a federal institute such as the National Institutes of Health or the CDC
- Training centers
- Independent research laboratories
- Re-Training programs
- Military schools, institutes, or training centers within a branch of the military
- Research institutes or National Laboratories that are owned by a Federal Government
- eLearning platforms or providers not directly owned and operated by an accredited academic University
- Bootcamps or independent learning platforms

SECTION: sales/qualification-questions.md

An effective questioning strategy is critical to engaging customers in dialogue that will help you truly understand their needs, build credibility and trust, and qualify the opportunity. Furthermore, effective discovery and needs analysis will be instrumental to your developing a tailored, compelling, customer-centric solution that will increase your chances to win the business and advance the buying decision.

Target buyer personas include CIO, CTO, VP of Application Development, Product Owner, and App Developer/DevOps Engineer.

CUSTOMER STRATEGY

Goal

- So that we may best understand your organization's needs and how we can help, what are your long-term goals for modernizing your application development practices to deliver increased value to the business?
- What are you trying to achieve and why are these goals important?
- What is your strategy for increasing the frequency of app deployments? If you were able to do this, what would the impact be to the business?
- How will you measure success for each of your goals?
- What is your cloud strategy?

Objectives

- With an understanding of your long-term goals, what are your key objectives for the next 6-12 months?
- What challenges are you experiencing with modernizing your application development practices?
- If you could address or improve one or a just a few things in your current DevOps stack implementation and execution, what would that be and why?
- What has prevented the move to <x> so far?
- What are the implications if these problems were to continue to persist?
- As you look into the future, what other challenges or obstacles do you anticipate encountering? What are you doing today to prepare for those challenges?
- What else is holding your team back from being even more successful?

Initiatives

- On what prioritized initiatives are you and your team currently focused?
- What initiatives are currently being planned or under consideration?
- Where is this interest/initiative coming from and what is the scope? (note: higher priority initiatives are often more likely to close and close more quickly)
 - Is it a company-wide or business unit-wide initiative? Or other?
- Do you have cloud-native initiatives? If so, what solutions are you exploring (i.e., Kubernetes)?

CUSTOMER NEEDS

Desired Outcomes

- What are the requirements you have for this project? What does success look like?
- How will success be measured?

Current Situation

- What can you tell me about your current situation?
- What led you to look at GitLab? (if applicable)
- What is your role and what do you do? (ideal roles: Infrastructure/Cloud/Enterprise Architects, Dev Ops, System Admin/Engineer, IT Managers/Directors, Release Engineer, VP Engineering)
- How would you describe what your group does?
- How large is your group? (goal: find out who will use GitLab and how large the opportunity

could be)

- How would you describe the projects on which your dev teams are currently working?
- If you were to rate how modern your organization's application development practices are on a scale of 1 to 5 (1 being not very modern at all, 5 being best-in-class modern), what would your rating be and why? What would it take to move the rating up?
- What tools are you currently using in your DevOps stack (or application development toolchain)?
 - What are you using for issue & bug tracking?
 - What are you using for CI?
 - What are you using for code review?
 - What tool(s) do you leverage for application deployment?
 - How would you describe your organization's current and future plans for adoption of the following:
 - Containers
 - VMs
 - Microservices
 - Kubernetes
 - What tools do you use for project management?
- What platforms/clouds are you deploying to? (AWS/GCP/Azure/VMWare/Openshift/other)
 - If AWS are you deploying to EC2, ECS, EKS, Fargate, or Lambda
 - If GCP are you deploying to GCE, GKE, App Engine, or Cloud Run
 - If Azure are you deploying to VMs, AKS, Functions
- How would you describe your maturity level/progress with continuous integration and continuous delivery Is this something your group and company want to improve upon?
- How are you using GitLab CE right now? (note: if applicable--check <https://version.gitlab.com/> to identify if their company is on CE)
- Are other groups using Git? If no, why not and what Version Control System(s) are they using? If yes, what are they using?
- How is security testing currently done in your organization?
- What is the current process for finding vulnerabilities around Static Application Security Testing, Dependency Scanning, and/or License Compliance?
- What is the financial impact on your organization/teams budget with other test and review tools?
- For additional customer use case-based discovery questions, please reference the following:
 - Version Control and Collaboration (VC&C)
 - Continuous Integration (CI)
 - DevSecOps
 - Agile Planning and Management
 - Continuous Delivery (CD)
 - GitOps

Level of Satisfaction

- How is your current application development & delivery tool stack working overall?
- What is working well?
- If you could change anything about it, what would that be and why?
- What elements are presenting the most challenges today? Why are those challenges proving to be so pesky?
- What are the underlying root causes for the issues you and the team are experiencing?
- What else do you need to be successful?

Personal Needs

- What's most important to you in accomplishing this objective(s)?
- What makes you personally so committed to the success of the project?
- What will it mean to you personally when the project is successful?
- What are the implications to you personally if it is not successful?
- What concerns you most?
- What is most important to you as it relates to your relationship with your supplier/partner?
- How do you prefer to work with your suppliers?
- What have you heard about and what are your perceptions of GitLab?
- Do you have any prior experience with GitLab? How did you find out about us?

CUSTOMER DECISION

Decision Process

- How would you describe the decision-making process at your organization?
- How many individuals or teams are involved in the decision making process?
- What executive or senior level sponsorship is required?
- Does each team/group purchase their own solutions or is there a department who does this? If a centralized department, what is that group's name?
- How does high availability rank within your needs and what you are trying to accomplish?

Decision Criteria

- What criteria will be used in making a decision?

Budget and Timeline

- When are you looking to implement? What is driving that timeline and is there any flexibility in the timeline?
- To what extent is there a compelling event (or series of events) that are influencing/impacting the timeline? What else can you tell me about that?
- What budget and resources have been allocated to this project?

Competitors

- Are you considering other Git-based offerings? If so, who?
- What other suppliers/vendors/solutions are you considering and/or evaluating?
- How is GitLab viewed in comparison to the other suppliers?

Time to Value

- Tell me about the most important things that need to be done to make the rollout successful.
- Describe to me where you think there may be opportunities to accelerate your time-to-value?
- How much time could we save your teams by having a GitLab expert architect and deploy GitLab for you?
- How would the business benefit from the ability to quickly and easily migrate teams?
- Describe how your developer productivity would be impacted by education around best practices for using GitLab, git or GitLab CI/CD

- How does your team manage the risk associated with adding a new tool or platform?

QUESTIONS FOR SELLING GITLAB PREMIUM AND ULTIMATE

The key to identifying more GitLab Premium and GitLab Ultimate opportunities is to truly embrace a consultative mindset with your prospect and customer engagements. More specifically:

- First, ensure you have an intimate understanding of the customer challenges and use cases that each version helps our customers address
 - See the [Why Premium?](#) page
 - See the [Why Ultimate?](#) page
- And more importantly, ask effective, open-ended discovery questions and actively listen to your customer's responses to determine if and how the capabilities of these versions map to the required capabilities they need to deliver desired outcomes for their organization.

Discovery Questions for GitLab Premium

Overview

GitLab Premium helps organizations increase operational efficiencies and deliver better products faster. With GitLab Premium, organizations may scale their DevOps delivery supporting high availability, geographic replication, progressive deployment, advanced configuration, and consistent standards. Are these capabilities important to your customer? Consider asking the below questions to find out.

Enterprise level Support

- What is the impact of outages and downtime with your SDLC toolchain?
 - If the impact is large, position Priority Support as a required capability
- How important is priority support to your organization?
 - Standard support: Next business day support (response within 24 hours 24x5)
 - Priority support: 4 hour response time for regular business support and 24x7 uptime support with a guaranteed 30 minute response time (best choice for minimizing outages and downtime)
- How confident are you in your team's ability to roll out GitLab? What would be the impact if you had expert help to assist in guiding, planning, and shaping your deployment and implementation?
 - Position how Customer Success Manager access can help to mitigate deployment risk, accelerate time to value, and optimize ROI and TCO
- How do you normally handle software upgrades? Would it be helpful to have GitLab support to help you through the process to ensure there aren't any surprises?
 - If yes, position GitLab's Upgrade Assistance

Achieve High Availability and Disaster Recovery

- What is your organization's HA (High Availability) strategy? Do you have one? Why / why not?
 - If HA support is needed, position Premium's HA support via our Reference Architectures; note: Free offers HA capabilities with self-support vs. expert GitLab support
- How does your organization handle Disaster Recovery?
 - GitLab's Disaster Recovery feature, only available in Premium and Ultimate SKUs, handles fail-over to another data center within minutes

- Are your development teams centrally located in generally the same vicinity or are they distributed across the world? If distributed, how do you ensure that latency between geographically dispersed developers is minimized?
- If this is important to the customer, discuss with your SA whether or not Geographic Replication is a required capability

Developer Productivity

- How important is it for you to maximize the productivity of your development teams?
- If you could change one thing to make your developers more productive, what would it be and why?
- If you were able to analyze graphs and reports to understand team, project, and group productivity to uncover patterns and best practices, how would that improve overall productivity?
- If this is of interest, position Productivity Analytics
- How does your organization currently track and manage code reviews and feedback?
- GitLab Premium includes built-in merge request reviews
- How important is having consistent and standard practices to boost overall developer productivity?
- Group and file templates allow you to share a set of templates for common file types with every project in a group
- What is your organization doing to simplify and streamline system logon processes for developers? Do you currently use or have plans to use SmartCard authentication?
- If yes, highlight Premium's Smart Card Authentication capabilities

Streamline Project Planning

- How do you currently handle project planning with your existing software development toolchain?
- If you could change one thing to streamline your project planning efforts, what would it be and why?
- How would your organization benefit from simplified management and visualization of work assignment and tracking?
- If streamlining project planning is important, consider positioning how the following capabilities can help your customer (see the Why GitLab Premium? page for value descriptions of each of these features)
- Group Backlog management - Simplify tracking, scoping and planning future work with group level backlog management on multiple issue boards
- Group Milestone Boards/Lists - Visualize future work to be delivered in future releases/milestones
- Assignee Boards/Lists - Streamline assignment of work to team members in a graphical assignment board
- Group Issue Boards - Visually manage programs (groups) with multiple issue boards where work can be dynamically assigned and tracked
- Issue Analytics - Establish consistent and standard practices

Deploy with Confidence

- How do you keep teams aligned and working on the right things at the right times?
- Epics - Organize, plan, and prioritize business ideas and initiatives

- Roadmaps - Visualize the flow of business initiatives across time in order to plan when future features will ship

- How many tools do you have to use to understand current status? How long does that take? How does that affect your teams?

- If this line of questioning reveals challenges in lack of visibility across the DevOps toolchain, position GitLab Premium's Operations Dashboard which provides a holistic view of the overall health of an organization's operations

- How would you assess your level of confidence in how your organization currently manages software deploys? Are there any risks you wish you could mitigate? If so, what are they and why? GitLab Premium offers a multitude of capabilities to allow organizations to deploy with confidence including the below (see the Why GitLab Premium? page for value descriptions of each of these features)

- Multi Project Pipelines - Link CI pipelines from multiple projects to deliver integrated solutions

- Protected Environments - Establish controls and limit the access to change specific environments

Manage Development

- How do you currently track and manage code reviews and feedback?

- Describe your current workflow between SCM to CI. When your pipeline fails, what's the process to remediate?

- If you could collaborate at the point of change, how would that affect your productivity?

- When is your next release? How at r